Although many Chinese negotiators speak foreign languages with a fair degree of fluency, they almost always use an interpreter. This is both a statement of their Chinese identity and a ploy that the negotiator utilizes to think through and formulate her or his response. Foreign negotiators often make the mistake of believing that the Chinese negotiators cannot speak their languages, and tend to discuss the subject of Chinese interest in the open without realizing that somebody in the Chinese delegation who has fluency over the foreign language, is taking mental notes. In a similar manner, the Chinese negotiator may also play the boor in public. This is only because it suits them to allow the other side to believe that they hold the advantage. Behind closed doors, they are effective communicators and tireless negotiators, equally skilled in closing a deal as in putting the onus of responsibility for failure on the other party.

Chinese negotiators usually do not immediately close a deal on the negotiating table on the basis of an oral consensus between the two parties. They will refer the draft text up the chain of decision makers for endorsement, and may open up the draft text again. This may appear to be a delaying tactic, but it is usually the case that the negotiator is not as empowered as his or her Indian counterpart, and may need the higher authority to authorize the deal. It is, therefore, prudent to hold back a little before striking the final deal, since the Chinese negotiator will usually revert on a provisional deal with the expectation of squeezing out a final concession. In short, the oral concurrence of the negotiator to any agreement is not the final word; it is only the written word that counts.

As a thumb rule, the Chinese never expose their leadership to the process of negotiation. It is out of character for a Chinese leader to take any new initiative up during his meeting with the Indian side. Chinese leaders will, therefore, almost never